EXAMPLE 2: WELL-KNOWN FAST-MOVING CONSUMER GOODS MOGUL

A nonfictional fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) company realizes that its R&D efforts across brands are disconnected. Each R&D team produces its data and stores this in a silo. There are also imprecisions and contradictions in the description language used. While performing similar or identical tests, various groups use different standard operating procedures. Their individual results are also described uniquely.

The initial effort of developing a data warehouse is stopped when the central data team fails to develop a harmonized data model. The lack of a common language (and often contradictory requirements) make it impossible.

An introduced data mesh helps in a couple of ways:

- The bottleneck of the central data team's need to cooperate with all the domains is removed. This team focuses on developing the data exchange platform and providing necessary metadata management tools.
- The domain teams no longer have to modify their data structures to multiple other domains. They put their effort into developing extensive documentation of their sources.

After decentralizing the effort, domain teams (having fully documented metadata concerning other datasets) can use to their advantage historical data produced by their counterparts. A spillover benefit also arises. Data harmonization occurs naturally when teams start to use and discuss one another's data. Over time, they also formulate a common language.

As you can see, the business case can range from the strategy-level company-wide cleanup to a single business process improvement. The approach and expected journey scale will differ, but the critical factor (business improvement) needs to be identified and quantified.

2.1.2 Organizational drivers